



THE BENIN CHORALE AND PHILHARMONIC NIGERIA

MEMORANDUM

NOTICE OF COMPULSORY RECITAL BCS MAY -AUGUST RECITAL EXERCISE

Dear Members,

The compulsory recital exercise scheduled for **May-August** forms an important aspect of our artistic and technical development as singers and musicians. Each student is expected to study, rehearse, and present the assigned classical aria or art song with musical sensitivity, proper diction, stylistic understanding, and confident stage presentation.

The selected repertoire has been carefully assigned according to voice classification and current vocal development. Members are encouraged to begin score study immediately, work consistently with accompanists and vocal coaches, and pay close attention to interpretation, pronunciation, breathing, phrasing, and memorization where required.

Compliance and Clearance Protocols

Please be informed of the following administrative requirements regarding this exercise:

- **Online Clearance:** No member of the ensemble will be cleared online if they have not met the prescribed pass mark.
- **Sanctions:** Completion of this clearance is mandatory. Appropriate sanctions will be meted out to any member who fails to secure clearance, as non-participation will be treated as an act of insubordination.

- **Certification:** Certificates of participation and merit will be awarded to eligible members at the end of the program.
- **Diaspora Participation:** Members residing in the diaspora who wish to participate in this exercise should contact the Director of Training and Research for specific guidelines.

This recital is not merely a means of continuous assessment, but an opportunity to cultivate discipline, artistry, and excellence in performance tradition. I encourage every participant to approach the preparation process with the seriousness and commitment worthy of the standards of the Benin Chorale and Philharmonic Nigeria.

I wish you all fruitful preparations and successful performances.



MUS. OSARODION EMMANUEL OTAMERE
Executive & Artistic Director
The Benin Chorale and Philharmonic Nigeria

CC:

The Registrar
The Directorate of Training and Research
The Director of ICT
Chairman, Jude's Committee
Directorate of Quality Assurance

SOPRANO SECTION

1. ESOHE GRACE AIFUWA (LEADER)

- **Option A:** *V'adoro, pupille* from "Giulio Cesare" (Handel) - Majestic, beautiful, great for a leader. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *O mio babbino caro* from "Gianni Schicchi" (Puccini) - A famous, sweeping, lyrical crowd-pleaser. [\[Download Score\]](#)

2. ELO-OBIGBA STELLA MARIS FBCP

- **Option A:** *Batti, batti, o bel Masetto* from "Don Giovanni" (Mozart) - Playful, sweet, and excellent for showing personality. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Caro mio ben* (Giordani) - The ultimate classic recital aria, elegant and smooth. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

3. INEGBENOSE PEPERTUAL O.

- **Option A:** *Lascia ch'io pianga* from "Rinaldo" (Handel) - Deeply emotional, slow, and beautiful. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Sebben, crudele* (Caldara) - A classic Italian recital piece, great for phrasing. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

4. BLESSING EGUABOR

- **Option A:** *Alma del core* (Caldara) - Upbeat, joyful, and energetic. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Deh vieni, non tardar* from "Le Nozze di Figaro" (Mozart) - Sweet, romantic, and lyrically demanding. [\[Download Score\]](#)

5. IDAHOSA FELICITY

- **Option A:** *Nel cor più non mi sento* (Paisiello) - Short, sweet, and lightly dramatic. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *O cessate di piagarmi* (Scarlatti) - Melancholic, focused on pure vowel sounds. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

6. EPHRAIM EMMANUEL

- **Option A:** *Gia il sole dal Gange* (Scarlatti) - Fast, triumphant, and excellent for showing vocal agility. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Amarilli, mia bella* (Caccini) - Early baroque, focuses on pure tone and expressive breathing. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

7. ONYINYE AMATOKWU

- **Option A:** *Pur dicesti, o bocca bella* (Lotti) - Light, graceful, and highly rhythmic. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

- **Option B:** *Se tu m'ami* (Parisotti) - Flirtatious, bouncy, and very fun to act out. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

8. ONAH KINGSLEY. O

- **Option A:** *Selve amiche* (Caldara) - Grand, sustained, and highly expressive. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Nina* (Pergolesi) - Emotional, beautiful, requires great storytelling. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

9. VICTORY ETTANNA, O

- **Option A:** *O del mio dolce ardor* (Gluck) - Lyrical, longing, and excellent for sustaining phrases. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Bel piacere* from "Rinaldo" (Handel) - Bright, tricky timing, very impressive. [\[Download Score\]](#)

10. AMARACHI S. NWABUISI

- **Option A:** *Vergin, tutto amor* (Durante) - Solemn, prayerful, and great for breath control. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Intorno all'idol mio* (Cesti) - Soothing, romantic, lullaby-like aria. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

11. EGIE PRAISE

- **Option A:** *Tu lo sai* (Torelli) - Short, passionate, allows for a great vocal crescendo. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Per la gloria d'adorarvi* (Bononcini) - Elegant, lilting, and sweet. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

12. CHIDERA OGBODO

- **Option A:** *Come raggio di sol* (Caldara) - Slow and sustained, great for building tone. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Danza, danza, fanciulla* (Durante) - Fast, energetic, and highly entertaining. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

13. OGE

- **Option A:** *Non posso disperar* (De Luca) - Beautifully contoured lines, highly classical. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Star Vicino* (Anonymous) - Simple, elegant, and perfect for a pure soprano voice. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

ALTO SECTION

1. EMEKA JOHN OKWECHIME (LEADER)

- **Option A:** *Che farò senza Euridice* from "Orfeo ed Euridice" (Gluck) - A highly dramatic Alto leader's aria. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Ombra mai fu* (Largo) from "Serse" (Handel) - Broad, majestic, showcases a warm, powerful lower register. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

2. PROMISE CHIDIMA PIUS

- **Option A:** *O rest in the Lord* from "Elijah" (Mendelssohn) - A comforting and famous English Oratorio aria. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Caro mio ben* (Giordani) - Elegant, smooth, a staple for classical recitals. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

3. VICTORY OGODO JUNIOR

- **Option A:** *Voi che sapete* from "Le Nozze di Figaro" (Mozart) - Charming, melodically brilliant (pants role). [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Sebben, crudele* (Caldara) - Great for phrasing and developing a rich lower tone. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

4. IKPOMWONSA PRECIOUS. O

- **Option A:** *Il mio bel foco* (Marcello) - Features a dramatic recitative followed by an energetic aria. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Lascia ch'io pianga* from "Rinaldo" (Handel) - Deeply emotional, slow, beautiful. [\[Download Score\]](#)

5. UMORU AGHATHA

- **Option A:** *Cara sposa* from "Rinaldo" (Handel) - Heartbreakingly beautiful, requires rich low notes. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Nel cor più non mi sento* (Paisiello) - Short, sweet, lightly dramatic. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

6. EIFEDIYI MARY-SUCCESS

- **Option A:** *Se tu m'ami* (Parisotti) - Flirtatious, light, and very fun to act out on stage. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Alma del core* (Caldara) - Upbeat, joyful, and energetic. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

7. RITA SENAMI IDOWU

- **Option A:** *O del mio dolce ardor* (Gluck) - Lyrical, longing, excellent for sustaining phrases. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

- **Option B:** *Amarilli, mia bella* (Caccini) - Focuses on pure tone and expressive breathing. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

8. OLOGBON PURITY GIFT

- **Option A:** *He Was Despised* from "Messiah" (Handel) - Highly emotional, serious English oratorio. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Nina* (Pergolesi) - Melancholic, beautiful, requires a great emotional connection. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

TENOR SECTION

1. OSAMUDIAMEN E. AIFUWA (LEADER)

- **Option A:** *Una furtiva lagrima* from "L'elisir d'amore" (Donizetti) - A world-famous tenor showpiece. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Comfort ye... Ev'ry valley* from "Messiah" (Handel) - Grand and agile English solos. [\[Download Score\]](#)

2. OKOH.O.DANIEL

- **Option A:** *Dalla sua pace* from "Don Giovanni" (Mozart) - Romantic, smooth, requires beautiful breath control. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Caro mio ben* (Giordani) - The ultimate classic recital aria, elegant and smooth. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

3. CHIDERA ARINZE.

- **Option A:** *Vittoria, mio core!* (Carissimi) - Very strong, loud, and triumphant. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Sebben, crudele* (Caldara) - A classic Italian recital piece, great for phrasing. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

4. OSAZEE AIGUEHIVEN

- **Option A:** *If with all your hearts* from "Elijah" (Mendelssohn) - A gorgeous, lyrical English oratorio aria. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Alma del core* (Caldara) - Upbeat, joyful, and energetic. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

5. TREASURE IRHIBHOGBE

- **Option A:** *Tu lo sai* (Torelli) - Short, passionate, allows for a great vocal crescendo. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Gia il sole dal Gange* (Scarlatti) - Fast, triumphant, excellent for showing vocal agility. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

6. BRIGHT UMOREN

- **Option A:** *Per la gloria d'adorarvi* (Bononcini) - Elegant and lilting. Great for a sweet tenor voice. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Nel cor più non mi sento* (Paisiello) - Short, sweet, and lightly dramatic. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

7. EFOSA.I. OSARENMWINDA

- **Option A:** *Sento nel core* (Scarlatti) - Expressive and slightly mournful; excellent for dynamics. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Amarilli, mia bella* (Caccini) - Early classical, focuses on pure tone and vowel shape. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

8. AKHAMIOJE .F. IMONA

- **Option A:** *Le Violette* (Scarlatti) - Bright, bouncy, and highly engaging for an audience. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *O del mio dolce ardor* (Gluck) - Lyrical, longing, excellent for sustaining phrases. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

9. IDEMUDIA. A. OSAMUDIAMEN

- **Option A:** *Total Eclipse* from "Samson" (Handel) - Highly dramatic and emotive English aria. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Pur dicesti, o bocca bella* (Lotti) - Light, graceful, and highly rhythmic. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

10. MICHAEL.I. ONYEMA

- **Option A:** *Panis Angelicus* (Franck) - A sacred standard that sounds incredibly beautiful for tenors. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Selve amiche* (Caldara) - Grand, sustained, and highly expressive. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

11. GERALD OSHORENUA

- **Option A:** *O cessate di piagarmi* (Scarlatti) - Melancholic, focused on pure vowel sounds. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Danza, danza, fanciulla* (Durante) - Fast, energetic, and highly entertaining. [\[Download High Voice\]](#)

BASS SECTION

1. OSAMUDIAMEN OSAZUWA. E (LEADER)

- **Option A:** *Non più andrai* from "Le Nozze di Figaro" (Mozart) - A famous, militaristic, and highly entertaining leader's aria. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Honor and Arms* from "Samson" (Handel) - A boasting, fast-paced aria that is very impressive for a Bass. [\[Download Score\]](#)

2. CHIDIEBERE.E EZE

- **Option A:** *O Isis und Osiris* from "The Magic Flute" (Mozart) - Extremely low, solemn, and powerful. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Caro mio ben* (Giordani) - Elegant, smooth, a staple for classical recitals. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

3. CHARLES XAVIER. E

- **Option A:** *Lord God of Abraham* from "Elijah" (Mendelssohn) - A dramatic, prayerful, and commanding English aria. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Vittoria, mio core!* (Carissimi) - Very strong, loud, and triumphant. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

4. OLUCHI OGBONNA

- **Option A:** *Come raggio di sol* (Caldara) - Slow, sustained, requires highly supportive breath. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Sebben, crudele* (Caldara) - A classic Italian recital piece, great for phrasing. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

5. PATRICK NWIBA

- **Option A:** *Si tra i ceppi* from "Berenice" (Handel) - Rhythmic, moving, excellent for showing bass vocal agility. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Alma del core* (Caldara) - Upbeat, joyful, and energetic. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

6. JOHN EIFEDIYI FBCP

- **Option A:** *Der Vogelfänger bin ich ja* from "The Magic Flute" (Mozart) - A famous, light, and very fun baritone/bass aria. [\[Download Score\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Gia il sole dal Gange* (Scarlatti) - Fast, triumphant, and excellent for showing vocal agility. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

7. OSAMUDIAMEN ETHAN

- **Option A:** *The Trumpet Shall Sound* from "Messiah" (Handel) - Majestic, grand, and features brilliant vocal runs. [\[Download Score\]](#)

- **Option B:** *Tu lo sai* (Torelli) - Short, passionate, allows for a great vocal crescendo. [\[Download Low Voice\]](#)

VIOLIN SECTION

1. GEORGE PAUL. C FBCP (CONCERT MASTER)

(As Concert Master, these pieces are highly respected, slightly showy Grade 4/5 standards).

- **Option A:** *Violin Concerto in A minor, RV 356 (1st Movement: Allegro)* by Antonio Vivaldi
 - **Style:** Fast, brilliant, standard violin showpiece. Requires crisp bowing and great energy.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(Look for "Violin and Piano" arrangement\)\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Pupil's Concerto No. 5 in D Major, Op. 22 (1st Movement)* by Friedrich Seitz
 - **Style:** Classical concerto style, great for showcasing shifting, double stops, and bright tone.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

2. UZOMBA JOSEPH-ELVIS. I

- **Option A:** *Violin Concerto in B minor, Op. 35 (1st Movement: Allegro moderato)* by Oskar Rieding
 - **Style:** Dramatic, sweeping, and an absolute staple of the Grade 4 repertoire.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Sarabande in G minor* by Carl Bohm
 - **Style:** Slow, majestic, and requires heavy, sustained bowing and rich vibrato.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(From "Albumblätter"\)\]](#)

3. MUS. EMMANUEL CHISOM NGENE

- **Option A:** *Air Varié No. 5 (on a theme by Pacini), Op. 89* by Charles Dancla
 - **Style:** A theme and variations piece. Very fun, elegant, and shows off different bowing techniques.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

- **Option B:** *Gavotte* by François-Joseph Gossec
 - **Style:** Light, bouncy, and highly recognizable. Great for spiccato (bouncing bow) practice.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

4. RHEMA STEPHEN

- **Option A:** *The Boy Paganini (Fantasia)* by Eduard Mollenhauer
 - **Style:** An impressive-sounding showpiece featuring harmonics and rich G-string playing.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Serenade (Ständchen)* by Franz Schubert
 - **Style:** Deeply lyrical and romantic. Beautiful for showcasing a singing tone on the violin.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(Look for Violin/Piano arr.\)\]](#)

5. OTOIBHI JOSEPHINE

- **Option A:** *Violin Concerto in G Major, RV 310 (1st Movement: Allegro)* by Antonio Vivaldi
 - **Style:** Bright, joyful, and highly rhythmic Baroque concerto.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Russian Fantasia No. 2 in D minor* by Leo Portnoff
 - **Style:** Moody, fast-paced, and sounds like traditional Eastern European dance music.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

6. STEPHEN ISRAEL

- **Option A:** *Concertino in G Major, Op. 24 (1st Movement)* by Oskar Rieding
 - **Style:** A delightful, standard classical piece that requires very clean intonation.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

- **Option B:** *Minuet in D Major, K.334* by W.A. Mozart
 - **Style:** Classical elegance. Requires delicate phrasing and strict tempo control.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(Look for Violin/Piano arr.\)\]](#)

7. ASEMOKHA .O. KENNEDY

- **Option A:** *Pupil's Concerto No. 2 in G Major, Op. 13 (3rd Movement: Rondo)* by Friedrich Seitz
 - **Style:** Fast, upbeat, and very engaging for the audience. Great for swift bow changes.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Sonata in F Major, HWV 370 (Mvts 1 & 2)* by G.F. Handel
 - **Style:** A serious, majestic Baroque sonata.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

8. ISREAL SOLOMON ETIM

- **Option A:** *Concertino in G Major, Op. 8 No. 4 (1st Movement)* by Adolf Huber
 - **Style:** Energetic and exciting; perfect for a Grade 4 student looking to show off confident bowing.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Humoresque, Op. 101 No. 7* by Antonín Dvořák
 - **Style:** A world-famous melody, playful, utilizing lots of bouncy bowing.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(Look for Violin/Piano arr.\)\]](#)

CELLO SECTION

1. JUDE ONYINYE DUMME FBCP

- **Option A:** *Tarantella, Op. 23* by William Henry Squire

- **Style:** Fast, rhythmic, and incredibly fun. A famous staple for Grade 4/5 cellists.
- **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Sonata in E minor, Op. 1 No. 2 (1st & 2nd Mvts)* by Benedetto Marcello
 - **Style:** A beautiful, lyrical Baroque sonata requiring rich tone on the lower strings.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

2. CHARLES OSAS AIYUDUBIE ESQ, FBCP

- **Option A:** *Sonata in C Major, Op. 40 No. 1 (1st Movement: Allegro)* by Jean-Baptiste Bréval
 - **Style:** The ultimate classical cello student piece. Bright, structured, and rewarding.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Sonata No. 5 in E minor, RV 40 (Largo and Allegro)* by Antonio Vivaldi
 - **Style:** Expressive, shifting between a gorgeous slow movement and an energetic fast movement.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

TRUMPET SECTION

1. ASUQUO HOPE JOHN

- **Option A:** *Petite Pièce Concertante* by Guillaume Balay
 - **Style:** A famous trumpet solo piece. Grand, lyrical, and tests standard Grade 4 range and phrasing.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *The Prince of Denmark's March (Trumpet Voluntary)* by Jeremiah Clarke
 - **Style:** The most famous triumphant classical trumpet piece. Great for a big, clear sound.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

2. OKAFRO MIRACLE

- **Option A:** *Prelude to "Te Deum"* by Marc-Antoine Charpentier
 - **Style:** A majestic, highly recognizable ceremonial fanfare. (Often used for weddings/royal events).
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(Look for Trumpet and Piano arr.\)\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Trumpet Concerto in E-flat Major (2nd Movement: Andante)* by Joseph Haydn
 - **Style:** Very lyrical, requires great breath control and a beautiful, singing tone.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

3. NCHEGE SIMEON

- **Option A:** *Trumpet Concerto in D Major, BWV 51:D7 (1st Movement: Adagio)* by G.P. Telemann
 - **Style:** A beautiful, singing baroque movement that requires good control of long phrases.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Andante and Allegro* by Guy Ropartz
 - **Style:** A staple contest piece. Starts smooth and slow, finishes fast and bold.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)

VIOLA SECTION

1. OKWECHIME JAMES.E

- **Option A:** *Viola Concerto in G Major, BWV 51:G9 (1st & 2nd Movements)* by G.P. Telemann
 - **Style:** The most famous classical piece for Viola. A must-learn for any advancing violist.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(Look for Viola/Piano arr.\)\]](#)
- **Option B:** *L'Agréable (from Five Old French Dances)* by Marin Marais

- **Style:** Elegant, rich, and perfect for showcasing the warm, deep tone of the viola.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here\]](#)
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SAXOPHONE SECTION

1. ARNOLD AIMUOSA

(Classical saxophone transcriptions usually played on Alto Sax)

- **Option A:** *Arioso (Sinfonia from Cantata BWV 156)* by J.S. Bach
 - **Style:** Extremely gorgeous, slow, and requires immense breath control and smooth legato playing.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(Look for Alto Saxophone arr.\)\]](#)
- **Option B:** *Habanera (from the opera "Carmen")* by Georges Bizet
 - **Style:** Playful, rhythmic, slightly seductive, and a massive crowd-pleaser.
 - **Score Link:** [\[Download here \(Look for Alto Sax/Piano arr.\)\]](#)

NOTE

FOR THE ORCHESTRA, these are **TWO Grade 4 standard pieces** assigned to each instrumentalist (ABRSM / Trinity comparable level). All scores are **free public-domain downloads from IMSLP** where available. You are to select one piece each. (For saxophone, I selected works commonly used at Grade 4 level; some are arrangements.)

For choir, a **clear two-aria option per person**.

Each member must **choose ONE of the two** for the BCS compulsory recital.

All links are **IMSLP public domain scores** (download piano–vocal version).